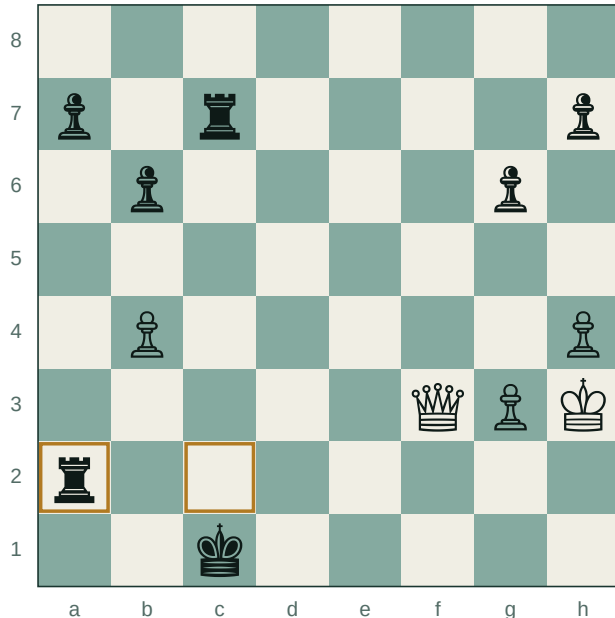


Queen-and-rook endings: White, move 50

Queen-and-rook endings

White to move



Previous move: 49...Rxa2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

50. Qf4+ Kb2 51. Qxc7

50.Qf4+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on c1 and rook on c7. Recorded reply: **50...Kb2**.

51.Qxc7 The queen captures the rook on c7.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 9 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Do not activate the king as casually as in a pure pawn ending. The remaining heavy pieces can still generate a mating net.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

When queens and rooks remain, mating threats coexist with endgame pawn races. Coordination and king shelter remain essential even on a sparse board.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for heavy-piece batteries, skewers, and checks that force a defender away from a promotion square or pawn.

The defending king is on c1. Geometrically undefended: rook on c7 and rook on a2. Check for tactical protection.